

Hyperconnect: Breaking down language barriers in video chats

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Google Cloud Platfor

- Allows people who speak different languages to communicate by speaking directly without breaking up the conversation happens with texting
- Expects to increase the satisfaction and the number of matches between users

Hyperconnect's mission is to expand the ability to connect with others without the barrier of time, language, and distance, connecting people of different backgrounds to grow worldwide cultural understanding. The Korean-based company launched its Android and iOS social discovery app Azar, which matches users from around the world and connects them instantly through video chats, allowing them to create a more personalized

About Hyperconnect

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Hyperconnect is a Korean-based IT company that develops software and mobile applications. The company's first product Azar is a mobile app targeted at connecting people through instant video chats. Hyperconnect specializes in developing WebRTC technology that has been used in many video chat platforms.

Industries: Technology

relationship. Since its launch, the app has been downloaded more than 60 million times in over 100 countries and 19 languages. Currently, Azar completes 30 million matches per day, and 80% of those matches are with people who speak different languages. Hyperconnect wanted to leverage Google Cloud capabilities and facilitate easier communication across languages to truly connect people and bridge the cultural divide. With Azar, Hyperconnect is expanding into a new area of messaging apps by creating meaningful virtual connections that extend beyond text-based conversations.

Location: Korea

Cloud Speech to Text

(<https://cloud.google.com/speech/>)

Cloud Translation API

(<https://cloud.google.com/translate/>)

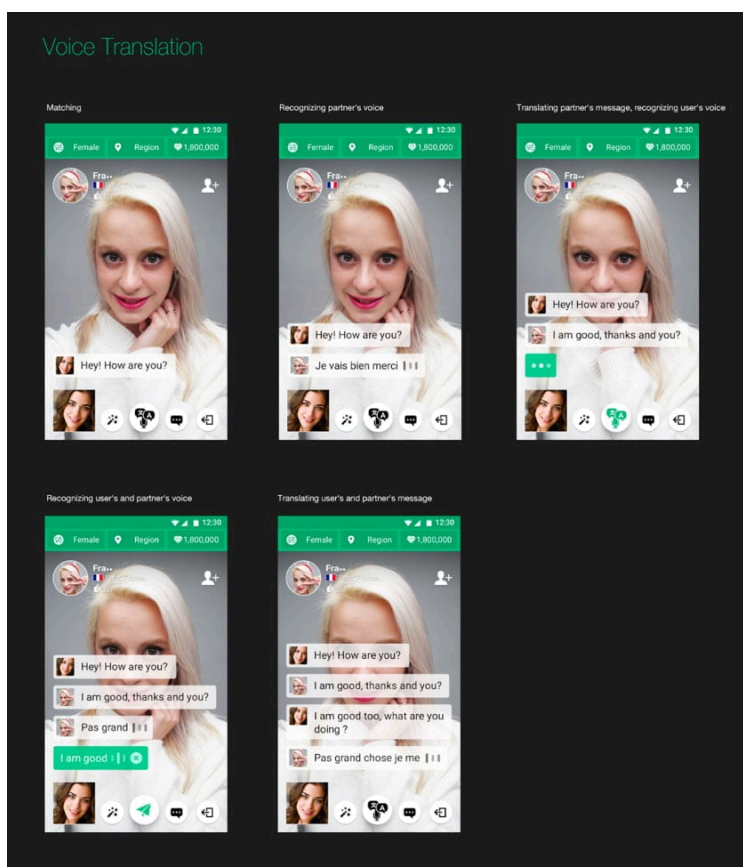
"People are constantly separated by barriers of time, language and distance. From these barriers conflict arises from misunderstandings of culture, religion and language. We want to connect people around the world and create the opportunity to learn more about other cultures from firsthand knowledge. We turned to Google Cloud Speech API and Google Cloud Translation API to help people understand each other when video chatting in Azar, even if they speak different languages," says JH Kim, vice president of business development at Hyperconnect.

Creating new connections across the language barrier

In a world with over 6,500 languages, Azar is trying to connect users by removing the language barrier. Currently, when a cross-language match happens, users are only able to communicate via text messaging. Hyperconnect wanted to make it easier for Azar users to make new international friends by

helping them communicate even if they don't speak the same language.

To do that, Hyperconnect chose Cloud Speech API, Cloud Translation API, and Cloud Messaging. Cloud Speech API converts speech into text, which is sent in a stream to Cloud Translation API. Cloud Translation API translates the stream, and Cloud Messaging then sends the translated text to Azar, which displays it in a speech bubble. Conversion and translation is instantaneous, so the flow of conversation is natural and without delays.



"We foster approximately 30 million matches a day, and half of those matches are between people who speak different languages. We realized that we had to add real-time translation to Azar to make it easier for our users to create deeper relationships with their new matches. Cloud Speech API helps us do that," Kim says.

Increasing user satisfaction, making face-to-face communication easier

The instant translation feature is still in testing on the Android app and has not yet been introduced into the iOS version. Based on initial results, the Hyperconnect team expects the translation feature to create deeper and more meaningful cross-language matches since communicating will be much easier. With Cloud Speech API and Google Cloud Translation API, users can see and hear their match instead of simply see them type. When users communicate via text, they lose the emotion conveyed through verbal communication, and facial features and reactions don't exist.

With Cloud Speech API, the company expects increased user satisfaction — as well as growth in the number of matches per day and longer, deeper conversations. All users are now able to connect without the worry of miscommunication.

“Google Cloud Speech API is helping us accomplish our core mission: to help anyone, anywhere communicate with others, no matter what language they speak,” Kim says.